What is AI

Term 3 | Week 5 | Lesson reference

AI is short for artificial intelligence. Some computer systems use patterns in examples to recognise things or suggest an answer. People build these systems. Their answers can be wrong.

Talk about these examples

Example	What could the AI system help with?
Speech recogniser	Suggest which words a person said. A person checks the words.
Picture recogniser	Suggest whether a picture shows a cat or a dog. A person checks the label.
Music recommendation	Suggest a song someone may like. The person decides whether to play it.
Simple on-off lamp	A fixed switch turns it on or off. This example does not need AI.

My example

Draw one helper and the job it does.

This system helps people to _____

People make machines

Teacher reads each card aloud. Point to things made by people. Then discuss which examples have a particular AI job. Being artificial does not automatically make something AI.

Things to discuss	Think and say
Tree | rock | spoon | toy car	Which are found in nature? Which are made by people?
Computer | simple lamp	Can both be useful without every task using AI?
A picture-recognition program	What picture does it need? Who checks its suggestion?

Remember

A computer is not alive.
A machine does not need to look like a robot.
A suggestion can be wrong.
A person should check.

Teacher answers

Tree and rock: natural. Spoon and toy car: human-made. A general computer may run AI software or non-AI software; its appearance alone does not tell us. In the examples, only the specific recognition or recommendation task is described as using AI.

Teacher references

Original SIAMIS activities informed by the sources below. These are adaptations, not reproduced publisher lesson plans. Links checked 21 October 2026.

Day of AI - AI Foundations for Early Childhood
https://dayofai.org/units/ai-foundations-grades-k-2-ages-5-7